Shivang Shelat

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Education

PhD, MA Cognition, Perception, & Cognitive Neuroscience 2023 –
University of California, Santa Barbara
Advisors: Dr. Barry Giesbrecht & Dr. Jonathan Schooler
Committee members: Dr. Tommy Sprague & Dr. Miguel Eckstein

BS Psychological & Brain Sciences *with highest honors* 2019 – 2023
University of California, Santa Barbara

Experience

Student Researcher, Human–Computer Interaction Group Jun. 2021 – Aug. 2023
NASA Ames Research Center – SJSURF
Advisor: Dr. Jessica Marquez

Lab Manager, META Lab Mar. 2021 – Jun. 2022
University of California, Santa Barbara
Advisor: Dr. Jonathan Schooler

Student Researcher, Increasingly Automated Air Cargo Operations Group Jun. 2020 – Sep. 2020
NASA Ames Research Center – SJSURF
Advisor: Dr. Richard Mogford

Selected Honors

Graduate Research Fellowship, *National Science Foundation* 2023 – 2026
Anastasi Graduate Student Research Award, *American Psychological Association* 2026
Mayer Award for Outstanding Research Contribution, *University of California, Santa Barbara* 2025
Software of the Year Honorable Mention (Team Award), *NASA* 2025
National Eye Institute Early Career Scientist Travel Grant, *Vision Sciences Society* 2024
Ames Honor Award, *NASA* 2023
Morgan Award for Research Promise, *University of California, Santa Barbara* 2022
Highest Honors at Graduation (top 2.5% of class), *University of California, Santa Barbara* 2022
Presidential Scholarship Award, *Teledyne Technologies* 2019

Publications

Peer-reviewed journal & proceedings papers

17 total – 9 first, 1 co-first, 6 second, 1 third author
student mentees underlined, equal contributions marked by asterisk

Homer, K. E., **Shelat, S.**, Karasinski, J. A., & Marquez, J. J. (in press). Off-topic chatter as an unobtrusive assessment of workload. *Human-Computer Interaction for Space Exploration, SpaceCHI*.

Shelat, S., Homer, K. E., Karasinski, J. A., & Marquez, J. J. (in press). Human–software trust over 45 days of simulated spaceflight. *Proceedings of the Human Factors and Ergonomics Society*.

Shelat, S., & Giesbrecht, B. (2026). Value-driven attentional capture prevents commission errors in real time. *Psychonomic Bulletin & Review*.

Shelat, S., & Schooler, J. W. (2026). The costs and benefits of mind-wandering: 13 years on. *Canadian Journal of Experimental Psychology / Revue Canadienne de Psychologie Expérimentale*.
featured in ***The Times***

Shelat, S., Marome, B., Lopez, C., Giesbrecht, B., & Schooler, J. W. (2026). The veil of distraction: Mind-wandering and memorability jointly shape visual recognition and recall. *Memory & Cognition*.
featured in ***The Current***

Marome, B.*, **Shelat, S.***, & Schooler, J. W. (2025). The phenomenology of encoding: Experience sampling reveals thoughts associated with the retention of visual and verbal materials. *Consciousness and Cognition*.

Shelat, S., Homer, K. E., Karasinski, J. A., & Marquez, J. J. (2025). Multidimensional usability assessment in spaceflight analog missions. *Human-Computer Interaction for Space Exploration, SpaceCHI 4.0*.

Shelat, S., & Giesbrecht, B. (2025). Perceptual decoupling in the sustained attention to response task is likely: Comment on Bedi, Russell, & Helton (2024). *Experimental Brain Research*.

Garg, A., **Shelat, S.**, Gross, M. E., Smallwood, J., Seli, P., Taxali, A., Sripada, C. S., & Schooler, J. W. (2025). Opening the black box: Think Aloud as a method to study the spontaneous stream of consciousness. *Consciousness and Cognition*.

Karasinski, J. A., **Shelat, S.**, & Marquez, J. J. (2025). Validation of self-scheduling countermeasures in NASA's HERA Campaign 6. *SciTech Forum*.

Garg, A., **Shelat, S.**, & Schooler, J. W. (2025). Now I feel like I'm going to get to it soon: A brief, scalable intervention for state procrastination. *BMC Psychology*.

Shelat, S., Marquez, J. J., Zheng, J., & Karasinski, J. A. (2024). Collaborative system usability in spaceflight analog environments through remote observations. *Applied Sciences*.

Shelat, S., Schooler, J. W., & Giesbrecht, B. (2024). Predicting attentional lapses using response time speed in continuous performance tasks. *Frontiers in Cognition*.

Zheng, J., **Shelat, S.**, & Marquez, J. J. (2023). Facilitating crew-computer collaboration during mixed-initiative space mission planning. *Human-Computer Interaction for Space Exploration, SpaceCHI 3.0*.

Marquez, J. J., **Shelat, S.**, & Karasinski, J. A. (2022). Promoting crew autonomy in a human spaceflight Earth analog mission through self-scheduling. *Accelerating Space Commerce, Exploration, and New Discovery, ASCEND*.

Shelat, S., Karasinski, J. A., Flynn-Evans, E. E., & Marquez, J. J. (2022). Evaluation of user experience of self-scheduling software for astronauts: Defining a satisfaction baseline. *Engineering Psychology and Cognitive Ergonomics, Lecture Notes in Computer Science*.

Young, A., Robbins, I., & **Shelat, S.** (2022). From micro to macro: The combination of consciousness. *Frontiers in Psychology*.

In progress

Nowinski, S.*, **Shelat, S.***, Skinner, H. E., Schooler, J. W., & Giesbrecht, B. (submitted). Remembered and felt mind-wandering across the vigilance decrement.

Shelat, S., Clubb, A. R., Giesbrecht, B.*, & Schooler, J. W.* (submitted). Social desirability bias obscures mind-wandering reports.

Garg, A., **Shelat, S.**, & Schooler, J. W. (submitted). Almost there: Mindfulness and the intention–behavior gap in procrastination.

Presentations

Conference posters

Shelat, S., & Giesbrecht, B. (in prep). Temporal stability of the spatial suppression gradient. In *Annual Meeting of the Vision Sciences Society*.

Shelat, S., Loftus, E. F., & Schooler, J. W. (2026). Mind-wandering and the suggestibility of visual memory. In *Psychonomic Society's 67th Annual Meeting*.

Clubb, A. R., **Shelat, S.**, & Schooler, J. W. (2026). Attentional derailment: When brief distractions become prolonged episodes. In *Psychonomic Society's 67th Annual Meeting*.

Shelat, S., Homer, K. E., Karasinski, J. A., & Marquez, J. J. (2026). Human–software trust over 45 days of simulated spaceflight. In *ASPIRE*.

Shelat, S., Clubb, A. R., Schooler, J. W., & Giesbrecht, B. (2025). Social desirability bias distorts self-reports of mind-wandering. In *Psychonomic Society's 66th Annual Meeting*.

Shelat, S., Schooler, J. W., & Giesbrecht, B. (2025). Catching the wandering mind with real-time triggers. In *Annual Meeting of the Vision Sciences Society*.

Shelat, S., & Giesbrecht, B. (2024). Value-driven attentional capture in a continuous performance task with real-time triggering. In *Psychonomic Society's 65th Annual Meeting*.

Tzetzo, A. G., **Shelat, S.**, Schooler, J. W., & Protzko, J. (2024). Phantom hurdles. In *Psychonomic Society's 65th Annual*

Meeting.

Shelat, S., & Giesbrecht, B. (2024). Real-time prevention of response inhibition failures via value-driven attentional capture. In *Institute for Collaborative Technologies: Cognitive Neuroscience Workshop*.

Shelat, S., Marome, B., Giesbrecht, B., & Schooler, J. W. (2024). Mind-wandering during encoding impairs recognition for both forgettable and memorable complex scenes. In *Annual Meeting of the Vision Sciences Society*.

Tzetzo, A. G., **Shelat, S.**, Schooler, J. W., & Protzko, J. (2024). Unfinished tasks turning into phantom hurdles. In *16th Annual Meeting of the Society for the Science of Motivation*.

Conference talks

Shelat, S., Thayer, D. D., Schooler, J. W., & Giesbrecht, B. (2026). Deep mind-wandering amplifies attentional capture. In *Annual Meeting of the Vision Sciences Society*.

Homer, K. E., **Shelat, S.**, Karasinski, J. A., & Marquez, J. J. (2026). Off-topic chatter as an unobtrusive assessment of workload. In *SpaceCHI*.

Shelat, S., Homer, K., Karasinski, J. A., & Marquez, J. J. (2025). Multidimensional usability assessment in spaceflight analog missions. In *SpaceCHI 4.0, virtual*.

Marquez, J. J., Zheng, J., **Shelat, S.**, Karasinski, J. A., & Bresina, J. (2024). Crew autonomy through self-scheduling: Guidelines for crew scheduling performance envelope and mitigation strategies. In *Human Research Program Investigators' Working Group Workshop*.

Marquez, J. J., **Shelat, S.**, Zheng, J., & Karasinski, J. A. (2023). Inferring collaboration strategies and usability from remote observations in a spaceflight analog environment. In *14th International Conference on Applied Human Factors and Ergonomics*.

Shelat, S., Karasinski, J. A., Flynn-Evans, E. E., & Marquez, J. J. (2022). Evaluation of user experience of self-scheduling software for astronauts: Defining a satisfaction baseline. In *International Conference on Human-Computer Interaction, virtual*.

Other talks

Clubb, A. R., **Shelat, S.**, & Schooler, J. W. (2026). Attentional derailment. In *Gene & Susan Lucas Scholars Showcase*.

Shelat, S. (2026). Spatial attention during mind-wandering. In *Seminar on Cognition, Perception, & Cognitive Neuroscience, University of California, Santa Barbara*.

Shelat, S. (2025). Experience-dependent capture prevents attentional lapses in real time. In *Annual Minicon, University of California, Santa Barbara*.

Mentoring

Undergraduate mentees

Casey Lopez 2024 –
next: Quantitative methodology RA with Dr. Delwin Carter

Brecken Marome 2023 – 2025
next: PhD student with Dr. Ed Awh, University of Chicago

Jordyn Wright 2025 – 2026
next: Lab manager with Dr. Julie Golomb, Ohio State University

Alexis Clubb 2024 – 2026
next: PhD student with Dr. Sonja Lyubomirsky, UC Riverside

Lily Swank 2024 – 2026
next: Residential staff at Northeastern University

Stanton Nowinski 2026 –
Charlie McGuinness 2025 –
Karina Mijangos Guzman 2023 – 2025
Avital Schwarz 2025
Nicole Friedman 2026 –
Hiya Kaul 2024 – 2026
Patrick Sperling 2025
Brandon Tran 2024

Undergraduate conference presentations

at UCSB's Undergraduate Research & Creative Activities (URCA) Annual Conference

Clubb, A. R., **Shelat, S.**, & Schooler, J. W. (2025). Self-presentation bias in mind-wandering reports.

Mijangos Guzman, K., **Shelat, S.**, & Giesbrecht, B. (2025). Affective signatures of hyperfocus during sustained attention.

Marome, B., **Shelat, S.**, & Schooler, J. W. (2024). Phenomenology of thought during memory encoding for verbal and visual material.

Service

Reviewing (ad hoc)

Acta Psychologica
BMC Psychology
Brain Research
Cognition and Emotion
Consciousness and Cognition
IEEE Aerospace
Personality and Social Psychology Bulletin
Proceedings of the Human Factors and Ergonomics Society
Scientific Reports

Committees & organizations

Undergraduate Experience Committee Representative 2025 –
managing student engagement initiatives and organizing annual awards ceremonies

Access Grads Mentor 2024 –
mentoring students interested in pursuing graduate school

Project Advisor – Staten Island Technical High School 2026
advised a high school team on testing the effects of music on memory encoding

Invited Discussant – Seattle University Ethics Bowl 2026
advised an undergraduate ethics team on the feasibility of memory manipulation

Fellowship & Grant Writing Panelist 2025
described experiences with applications to funding sources

NSF GRFP Advice Panelist 2025
described how to write statements of purpose and research plans

Teaching

As teaching assistant

PSY 120L: Laboratory in Advanced Research Methods scheduled Spring 2027
University of California, Santa Barbara
Instructor: Dr. Melinda Baham

PSY 118L: Laboratory in Attention Fall 2026
University of California, Santa Barbara
Instructor: Dr. Barry Giesbrecht

As invited guest lecturer

Individual Differences in Cognition: Mind-wandering Fall 2026
Eckerd College

Media Coverage

Why allowing your mind to wander can boost your brain – *The Times* ↪
On mind-wandering's benefits, with Kate McCann & Stig Abell – interview with *Times Radio Breakfast* ↪
Research in Review: Mind-wandering effects on recent memory – *The Daily Nexus* ↪
Lost in thought: How mind-wandering affects what we remember – interview with *KCSB-FM 91.9* ↪
Even brief lapses in attention can weaken memory – *The Current* ↪
Brief, scalable fix for overcoming state procrastination – *Scienmag* ↪
A two-minute fix for procrastination – *The Current* ↪